

Kali / Linux Shell Essentials

A daily shell reference: whoami, pwd, ls, find, grep, networking, processes, permissions, and basic system context.

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Usage note: Suitable for local Kali, SSH, or a Linux shell in a lab. Destructive commands are intentionally minimized.

IDENTITY

whoami / id

FILES

pwd / ls / cat

SEARCH

find / grep

NETWORK

ip / ss

Contents

1. Identity and system
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1. Identity and system

Start with these commands after SSH or obtaining a Linux shell.

LINUX SHELL — User identity

```
whoami
id
groups
```

LINUX SHELL — Host and OS

```
hostname
uname -a
cat /etc/os-release
arch
```

LINUX SHELL — Time and logged-in users

```
date
who
w
```

2. Navigation and files

Command	Meaning
pwd	Current path
ls -la	All files including hidden files
cd /path	Change directory
cd -	Return to previous directory
file name	File type
stat name	Metadata, permissions, timestamps
cat file	Read a short text file
less file	Read a long file
head -n 20 file	First 20 lines
tail -n 20 file	Last 20 lines

LINUX SHELL — Create/copy/move

```
touch note.txt
mkdir work
cp source dest
mv old new
```

LINUX SHELL — Delete carefully

```
rm file
rmdir empty_dir
```

Note: Do not use `rm -rf` randomly in a lab. Delete only what you created or what the task explicitly asks you to remove.

3. Search inside the system

LINUX SHELL — Find by filename

```
find /path -type f -name "*.conf" 2>/dev/null
```

LINUX SHELL — Find directory by name

```
find / -type d -iname "*backup*" 2>/dev/null
```

LINUX SHELL — Search file contents

```
grep -Rni "password" /path 2>/dev/null
```

Note: Limit /path to the lab objective. Searching the entire filesystem can be slow and unnecessarily broad.

LINUX SHELL — Locate a command

```
which python3
whereis ssh
command -v curl
```

4. Network and processes

LINUX SHELL — Interfaces and routes

```
ip a
ip route
ip neigh
```

LINUX SHELL — Listening ports

```
ss -ltnup
```

LINUX SHELL — Processes

```
ps aux
ps -ef
```

LINUX SHELL — Environment

```
env
echo "$PATH"
echo "$HOME"
```

5. Permissions and help

LINUX SHELL — Permissions

```
ls -l [FILE]
namei -l [PATH]
```

LINUX SHELL — Sudo rights

```
sudo -l
```

sudo -l shows commands allowed for the current account; use the result with the privilege-escalation reference.

LINUX SHELL — Help

```
man [COMMAND]
[COMMAND] --help
help [BUILTIN]
```

6. Short starting workflow

LINUX SHELL

```
whoami; id; hostname; pwd
uname -a; cat /etc/os-release
ip a; ip route
ls -la
ps aux | head
ss -lntup 2>/dev/null
```

After this baseline, move to the relevant Linux Post-Exploitation, Privilege Escalation, or File Transfer reference according to the lab objective.

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

GNU coreutils documentation

iproute2 / procps manual pages

Project: [Linux_Post_Exploitation_Cheatsheet.html](#)